

Amendment Number 004
RFP Number 75N98026R00042
Title: NIH PROFESSIONAL, SCIENTIFIC AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT SERVICES (PSTSS)

Amendment Issue Date:

Friday, April 24, 2026

Issued By:

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Proposal Due Date/Time:

Monday, May 8, 2026, at 3:00 PM ET (Changed).

The purpose of this amendment is to revise the proposal submission deadline from May 4, 2026, at 3:00 PM (ET) to May 8, 2026 at 3:00 PM (ET) and to address multiple questions regarding discrepancies between Labor Categories in Attachment 3 – Statement of Work and Attachment 10 – Table of Labor Rates and Unit Prices. The Government has revised Attachment 10 to ensure alignment and to reflect all labor categories and associated labor category levels. Offerors are directed to reference the revised version of Attachment 10 when preparing and submitting their proposals. Please note that Attachment 10 includes detailed labor category level breakdowns, whereas the Statement of Work references the overarching labor categories (e.g., Animal Biologist I in Attachment 10 - Table of Labor Rates and Unit Prices versus Animal Biologist in Attachment 3 - Statement of Work). Please note that some questions are still under review, and corresponding responses will be provided and posted by the Government as soon as practicable. The Government will not be accepting any additional questions.

Offerors must acknowledge receipt of this amendment by identifying this amendment number and date of the amendment on each copy of the proposal submitted. Failure to receive your acknowledgement may result in the rejection of your proposal. Except as provided herein, all terms and conditions of the solicitation remain unchanged and in full force and effect.

Question	Answer
HSPD- 12 must be addressed in a separate section entitled "Information Security". Can the government provide any further instructions on what needs to be included?	Per Page 88 and 89 of the RFP, "All Contractor (and/or any subcontractor) employees must obtain a background investigation commensurate with their position sensitivity designation that complies with Parts 1400 and 731 of Title 5, Code of Federal Regulations (CFR). The following position sensitivity designation levels apply to this solicitation/contract: [] Tier 5: Critical Sensitive and Special Sensitive National Security, including Top Secret, SCI, and 'Q' access eligibility. [] Tier SSR: Reinvestigation. [] Tier 4: High Risk Public Trust (HRPT). [] Tier 4SR: Reinvestigation. [] Tier 3: Non-Critical Sensitive, National Security, including Secret and 'L' access eligibility. [] Tier 3SR: Reinvestigation. X] Tier 2S with Subject Interview: Moderate Risk Public Trust (MRPT). [] Tier 2SR: Reinvestigation. [] Tier 1: Low Risk, Non-Sensitive, including HSPD-12 Credentialing. 6. Homeland Security Presidential Directive (HSPD)-12 The Contractor (and/or any subcontractor) and its employees must comply with Homeland Security Presidential Directive (HSPD)-12, Policy for a Common Identification Standard for Federal Employees and Contractors; OMB M-05-24; OMB M-19-17; FIPS 201, Personal Identity Verification (PIV) of Federal Employees and Contractors; HHS HSPD-12 policy; and Executive Order 13467, Part 1 §1.2. For additional information, see HSPD-12 policy at: https://www.dhs.gov/homeland-security-presidential-directive-12 ."
Can the government provide a detailed estimate on the number of awards?	Per the RFP on Page 6 and Page 146, "This is a Multiple Award Indefinite Quantity contract as contemplated by FAR 16.504. The minimum guaranteed order will be \$2,000 per IDIQ contract, and the maximum total portfolio ceiling (all contracts combined) value will be \$3,000,000,000. It is anticipated that multiple awards will be made from this solicitation and that the awards from this solicitation will be multiple-year Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) type contracts with a five (5) year ordering period. The minimum guaranteed order will be \$2,000 per IDIQ contract and the maximum total portfolio ceiling (all contracts combined) value will be \$3,000,000,000. It is anticipated that task orders issued against these contracts will be cost reimbursement, time and materials/labor hour, and fixed price type Task Orders."
Can the Government clarify whether a specific number or target percentage of awards will be reserved for small businesses?	RFP states the anticipated minimum goals for Small Business this RFP is 33.25%.
Provides instructions for the business proposal to include a "Information Security" section to address HSPD-12 and FISMA requirements. Since IT requirements will be determined at the Task Order level and not the IDIQ can you please clarify if an Information Security Plan is required for the IDIQ Proposal Submission?	If this is required, it will be determined at the Task Order Level.
If an Information Security Plan/SSP is required at the IDIQ level can you please provide the system requirements the government is requesting (type of data stored, amount of data, access requirements, etc.)?	If this is required, it will be determined at the Task Order Level.
The table denotes that key personnel are "To be specified prior to award". Can the government specify which positions, if any, are considered "key personnel" and/or "essential to work performance"?	The Project Director as the only designated Key position. All other Key

Can the government clarify how cost realism and price competitiveness will be weighted relative to technical factors at the task order level?	Please see Section M - Evaluation Factors for Award, beginning on Page 126 of the RFP
Will offeror's proposed indirect rates be evaluated at the IDIQ level or applied at the TO level? If it is not at the TO level, what documentation is acceptable for pricing purposes for cost realism.	Please see Section M - Evaluation Factors for Award, beginning on Page 126 of the RFP
Would the government please provide a listing of what attachments are to be included in both the technical and business volumes?	Please refer to Attachment 4: Additional Technical Proposal Instructions and Attachment 5: Additional Business Proposal Instructions
The attachment titled "Technical Proposal Cost Summary" is missing from the Section J Attachments. Would the government please provide this attachment.	Please disregard. This attachment is not included as part of the RFP.
On page 100 there is a requirement for Past Performance information (item m) but the instructions under Attachment 4, Technical Proposal Instructions- Corporate Experience, do not align with this requirement. Please confirm that the requested Past Performance information on page performance on page 100 is to be included as part of the business volume and indicate how it will be evaluated.	Please refer to SECTION M - Evaluation Factors for Award for evaluation factors. Per page 87 of the RFP, m. Past Performance Information a. Offerors shall submit the following information as part of their Business proposal."
Item h on page 116 indicates the technical proposal should include a section called "technical discussions" requests offerors to address the Statement of Work Objectives, Approach, Methods and Schedule. These items do not seem to have a corresponding section under Section M and are not in alignment with Attachment 4. Given the limited page count, can the Government help to clarify what is REQUIRED within the technical proposal or if all elements (those listed on pages 116-118 plus Attachment 4) are to be adhered to.	Per Page 103 of the RFP, "The technical proposal should reflect a clear understanding of the nature of the work being undertaken. The technical proposal must include information on how the project is to be organized, staffed, and managed. Information should be provided which will demonstrate your understanding and management of important events or tasks." The technical evaluation committee will review the complete technical proposal in addition to the evaluation factors listed in Section M. Per the RFP, "These additional Technical Proposal instructions reflect the requirements of the solicitation and provide specific instructions and formatting for the Technical Proposal. While Section L of the RFP provides a generic set of Technical Proposal instructions applicable to all solicitations, these instructions are tailored to the specific requirements of the RFP. The information requested in these instructions should be used to format and prepare the Technical Proposal and should be used as a Table of Contents for your Technical Proposal. Offerors should follow the instructions in Section L of the solicitation, and include the information requested herein."
Page 119 at 3(a) and B (page 120) indicate that the cost/price information should include travel, materials (including raw materials), subcontracts, purchased parts, shipping, and special equipment. Further page 160 at Attachment 5 (page 2) in Section C indicates that profit on ODCs is limited to 10% of estimated costs. However, Attachment 10, Table of Labor Rates and Unit Prices allows for only full billable rates to be populated along with the total price based on the hours provided. Please confirm that the government only wants labor rates for the proposal submission (Attachment 10) and the other items will be priced at the TO level as stated on page 161 at Attachment 5 (page 3), Section 4: Uniform Cost Assumptions.	Confirmed.
Please confirm the proposed costs should just be labor bill rates to include the direct labor, fringe	

Please confirm that offerors should align their technical proposal to Attachment 4. The other set of technical proposal instructions seem to apply to task orders based on the extensive list of potential LCATs, the reference to project methodologies and project schedules for the completion of work, along with key personnel resumes, which can only be known at the task order level.	Per Page 103 of the RFP, "The technical proposal should reflect a clear understanding of the nature of the work being undertaken. The technical proposal must include information on how the project is to be organized, staffed, and managed. Information should be provided which will demonstrate your understanding and management of important events or tasks." The technical evaluation committee will review the complete technical proposal in addition to the evaluation factors listed in Section M. Per the RFP, "These additional Technical Proposal instructions reflect the requirements of the solicitation and provide specific instructions and formatting for the Technical Proposal. While Section L of the RFP provides a generic set of Technical Proposal instructions applicable to all solicitations, these instructions are tailored to the specific requirements of the RFP. The information requested in these instructions should be used to format and prepare the Technical Proposal and should be used as a Table of Contents for your Technical Proposal. Offerors should follow the instructions in Section L of the solicitation, and include the information requested herein."
Is the Attachment 9: HHS Subcontracting Plan Template form the same requirement as the Small Business Subcontracting Plan requested in Section H, Item 7.a. and in Section L.3. Business Proposal Instructions, Alternate I (October 2010) of FAR Clause 52.215-20, para (b)(1)j.b.?	Confirmed
Will the Government provide an exemption to the hyperlink restriction for the annual report in the Business Vol?	The Government will not provide an exemption to the hyperlink restriction. Offerors shall comply with all proposal preparation instructions.
Will the Government please clarify if there is a defined amount of working capital needed at any given point in time to demonstrate complete financial capacity?	"The offeror shall indicate if it has the necessary financial capacity, working capital, and other resources to perform the contract without assistance from any outside source. If not, indicate the amount required and the anticipated source."
Page 83 states that the Technical Proposal 50-page limit "does not include the cover sheet, abstract, table of contents, personnel, facilities, equipment and resources, other considerations, schedule, other support, cost information, and literature cited." Page 129 states that the 50-page limit "does not include: Title and Back Page; Table of Contents; and Section Dividers that do not contain information other than Title of Section." Will the government please clarify what is not included in page limits? Will the government please also clarify if "personnel" refers to key personnel resumes?	The page limit is 50 pages single-sided/25 pages double-sided. The following do not count towards the page limit for the Technical Proposal: cover sheet, abstract, table of contents, personnel, facilities, equipment and resources, other considerations, schedule, other support, cost information, literature cited, Title & Back Page, Table of Contents, and Section Dividers that do not contain information other than the Title of Section. Personnel as referenced on Page 96 refers to the resume and letter of commitment of Key Personnel. These do not count towards the page limits. A list of figures, tables, and/or acronyms are not requested inclusions. If included, they will count towards the total page count.
Will the Government please confirm that the Technical Proposal Instructions apply only to the TO level and not to the IDIQ level submission?	The Technical Proposal should be in as much detail as you consider necessary to fully explain your proposed technical approach or method. It should show a clear understanding of the nature of the work being undertaken.
HHS Subcontracting Plan Template lists the HHS subcontracting goals for Fiscal Year 2022. Will the government please provide an updated template with the 2026 HHS subcontracting goals?	33.25% is the minimum goal for small business per the HHS Subcontracting Plan Template (Attachment 9

Attachment 10: Table of Labor Rates and Unit Prices
Title: NIAID Professional, Scientific and Technical Support Services (PSTSS)
RFP Number 75N93024R00013

Labor Category	Base Period				Year 2				Year 3				Year 4				Year 5				52.217-8 (6 Month POP)			
	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
Specialized Professional, Scientific, and Technical Support Services																								
Animal Biologist 1	13,440	Hours			86,016	Hours			86,016	Hours			86,016	Hours			86,016	Hours			43,008	Hours		
Animal Biologist 2	0	Hours			0	Hours			0	Hours			0	Hours			0	Hours			0	Hours		
Animal Biologist 3	13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			6,720	Hours		
Animal Biologist 4	13,440	Hours	</																					

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Data Scientist 2	13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				6,720	Hours	
Data Scientist 3	13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				6,720	Hours	
Data Scientist 4	25,560	Hours				25,560	Hours				25,560	Hours				25,560	Hours				12,780	Hours	
Data Scientist 5	24,960	Hours				24,960	Hours				24,960	Hours				24,960	Hours				12,480	Hours	
Echo Technologist 1	13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				6,720	Hours	
Echo Technologist 2	13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				6,720	Hours	
Epidemiologist 1	13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				13,440	Hours				6,720	Hours	
Epidemiologist 2	13,440	Hours																					

Title: NIAID Professional, Scientific and Technical Support Services (PSTSS)

RFP Number 75N93024R00013

Program Analyst 3	24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			12,480	Hours		
Project Manager 1	13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			6,720	Hours		
Project Manager 2	130,400	Hours			134,400	Hours			130,400	Hours			130,400	Hours			65,200	Hours		
Project Manager 3	13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			13,440	Hours			6,720	Hours		
Project Manager 4	24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			12,480	Hours		
Project Manager 5	24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			12,480	Hours		
Project Manager 6	43,000	Hours			43,000	Hours			43,000	Hours			43,000	Hours			21,500	Hours		
Project Manager 7	24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			24,960	Hours			1			